

Lacerta schreiberi

Schreiber's green lizard



Length 14 in (36 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Status Near threatened

Location S.W. Europe



Schreiber's green lizard is typical of the numerous localized species of "wall lizards" that are found in different parts of Europe. The male is green, with

scattered, small black spots, and a blue throat or head (sometimes both) in the breeding season. The female is brown or bright green, with large black markings and a brown head. The young are green with white or yellow, black-edged bars on their flanks. This lizard can be found basking in the open in fields, moorland, or hillsides, often near streams, occupying a position with a good, all-around view. It mostly sits and waits for insects to come within range, but also forages in cracks. When disturbed, it retreats into a burrow or dives into water, hiding under stones on the streambed. If attacked, it can easily discard its tail. This lizard has a lifespan of over 10 years in captivity. The female lays 6–12 eggs at a time.



Timon lepidus

Eyed lizard



Length 16–32 in (40–80 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Near threatened

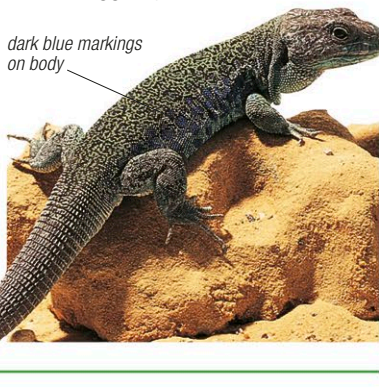
Location S.W. Europe



Also known as the ocellated or jeweled lizard, this thickset green animal, with blue eyespots running along its flanks, is Europe's largest lizard. It inhabits hillsides, fields, and clearings, foraging for

large insects, birds' eggs, nestlings, other lizards, and small mammals. Although it hibernates in winter, it may emerge on warm days. If grasped, it bites, discards its tail, and retreats into its burrow. Females lay a single clutch of 6–16 eggs a year.

dark blue markings on body



Podarcis lilfordi

Lilford's lizard



Length 7–9 in (18–22 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Endangered

Location Balearic Islands



This tough, adaptable lizard can survive in remarkably hostile environments. Although it has few predators (there are no snakes on many of the islands it inhabits), vegetation is

sparse and food is scarce, posing the greatest threat to this lizard's survival. It is an active forager, scrambling over rocks and shrubs in a relentless search for food—insects, fishes dropped by seabirds, and food discarded by tourists, as well as flowers and leaves. Some populations are entirely black, while others are brown or green. The female lays about 4 eggs in crevices filled with soil or leaves, or under shrubs.

turnip-shaped tail stores fat



Zootoca vivipara

Viviparous lizard



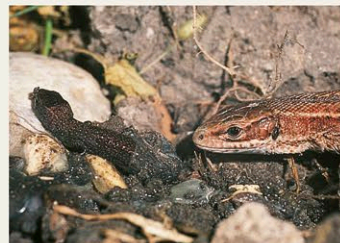
Length 4–4½ in (10–12 cm)
Breeding Viviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Least concern

Location Europe to C. and E. Asia (including Japan)

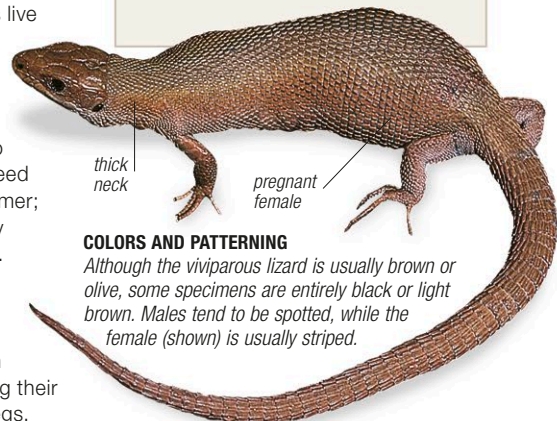


Also known as the common lizard, this species has one of the largest continuous ranges of any terrestrial reptile, reaching well into the Arctic. It is the only member of its genus that bears live young—an adaptation that helps it survive in regions that are too cold for eggs to develop. In the far north of its range, it can hibernate for up to 8 months at a time and may breed only every second or third summer; however, it makes up for this by having a relatively long lifespan. Viviparous lizards live on the ground, usually in dense vegetation, and feed mainly on insects and spiders. They often bask on a sunny bank, flattening their body and spreading out their legs.

BREAKING OUT



Young viviparous lizards are born in an egg membrane from which they escape almost immediately. They are about 1½ in (4 cm) long and black. In the southern parts of their range—in the Pyrenees—viviparous lizards sometimes lay eggs.



COLORS AND PATTERNING

Although the viviparous lizard is usually brown or olive, some specimens are entirely black or light brown. Males tend to be spotted, while the female (shown) is usually striped.

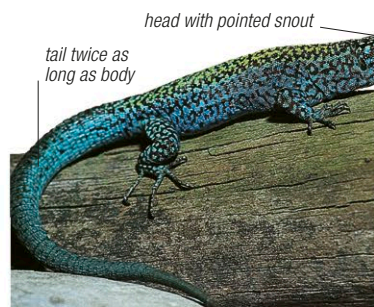
Podarcis pityusensis

Ibiza wall lizard



Length 6–8½ in (15–21 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Near threatened

Location Balearic Islands



tail twice as long as body

head with pointed snout

With its slender body and long toes, the Ibiza wall lizard is an agile climber. It is most often seen basking on walls, rocky slopes, and fallen trees—sometimes in large numbers—but it invariably scuttles away rapidly if disturbed. Males are generally blue with black markings, while females often have dark stripes, but the colors and patterns of both sexes vary across the species' range. Wall lizards feed on insects, and they lay their eggs in burrows or under stones. The Ibiza wall lizard can live for up to 6 years.

Chalcides ocellatus

Eyed skink



Length 12 in (30 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Burrowing
Status Not evaluated

Location S. Europe, N. and N.E. Africa, W. Asia



Also known as the ocellated skink, the eyed skink has a stocky, light brown or yellowish brown body with small, white eyespots surrounded by black. Its smooth, glossy scales and small limbs are adaptations to a burrowing lifestyle. Although this lizard is mainly active during the day, it may also be active at dusk in very hot weather. It is often found basking near old ruins or drystone walls near olive groves, never straying far from cover. If threatened by birds, snakes, and cats, it darts into its burrow or into crevices between rocks; if attacked, it may shed its tail. An active forager, the eyed skink searches under stones for small insects and spiders. It lives in loose colonies, and the female lays 3–10 eggs.

small limbs aid burrowing

head narrower than body

no distinct neck

